



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Charis Classical School

School Website: <https://www.charisclassicalfw.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Overall classification: CLASSICAL School: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org) Why: The school's public materials repeatedly affirm truth, goodness, and beauty; virtue and wisdom as aims; the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Latin; memory work with songs and chants; upper□school debate, discussion, and senior thesis; explicit Christian theological integration; and a deep parent co□teacher model. These are strong positive matches to the Six Essential Elements classical lexicon and criteria used in this audit. Method: For each of the six categories below, I extracted keywords and phrases from the school's materials, compared them against the positive/negative indicators in Six Essential Elements, tallied positive vs. negative hits, estimated percent coverage of the sub□criteria, and assigned a category rating accordingly.

URL used for audit: <https://austinclassical.org>

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Required criteria: - Transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty as real, knowable) - Grounded in theology - Liturgical and communal practices (chapel/worship/liturgy)

1) Keywords/phrases found in school materials (evidence):

- "glorify Jesus Christ" (mission)
- "wise, virtuous, and humble" students (virtue, humility)
- "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" (multiple instances)
- "interrelatedness of all knowledge under the sovereignty of God through theology"
- "image of God" and "God's goodness, truth, and beauty"
- Christian Studies sequence: Doctrine/Church History, Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics (explicit theology)

2) Comparison to Six Elements positive/negative indicators:

- Positive matches to "truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom" and theological integration (theology, Christian formation, apologetics) align strongly with the Religious & Metaphysical foundation keywords; no counter□signals (e.g., "values□neutral," "secular," "religiously neutral") were found.
- No explicit references found to "chapel," "liturgy," or "daily worship," so the liturgical communal practice sub□criterion is less evident.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive keyword hits: +12
- Negative keyword hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage of sub□criteria: ~0.67 (clear on moral realism and theology; limited direct evidence of liturgy/chapel)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL Rationale: Strong transcendental moral realism and explicit theological grounding; liturgical/chapel language not prominent, but the first two sub□criteria are robustly met.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Required criteria: - Goal: cultivation of virtue and wisdom - Education as formation (not mere information) - Affirmation that humans can know the true, good, and beautiful

1) Keywords/phrases found in school materials:

- “cultivate wisdom and virtue” and “teach our children truth, goodness, and beauty”
- “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose” (formation over utility)
- “joyful, life-long learning” and “at leisure to study and to play” (education for leisure/scholé)

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Direct matches to cultivation of “wisdom,” “virtue,” pursuit of “truth, goodness, beauty,” and formation language; presence of “leisure” aligns with scholé/restful learning aims in the purpose/goal lexicon; no “college-and-career readiness” marketing emphasis observed.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +10
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage: 1.00

4) Rating: CLASSICAL Rationale: Explicit, repeated purpose statements match the classical telos and formation language.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Required criteria: - Liberal Arts (Trivium; Quadrivium) - History (not “Social Studies”) - Great Books/Great Conversation - Integration and cultivation of wonder

1) Keywords/phrases found in school materials:

- Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) explained and implemented; Latin instruction; formal logic; rhetoric course; senior thesis
- “great books,” “great conversation,” “great works of the Western tradition”
- High school plan shows “History” as the term, not “Social Studies”
- “interrelation of all knowledge... under the sovereignty of God” (integration)

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Strong positive matches for Trivium/Latin, Great Books/Conversation, integration across subjects; explicit “History” usage aligns with classical phrasing; “wonder” is implied via “curiosity” and “beauty” aims, though the word “wonder” is not prominent.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +12
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage: ~0.75 (Trivium, Great Books, Integration all explicit; Quadrivium specifics mostly implied via music/choir, not fully enumerated)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL Rationale: Clear Trivium/Latin/Great Books core, integrated curriculum, and classical history approach.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

Required criteria: - Restful/Contemplative aspects (scholé, leisure) - Lower□school singing/chanting/recitation/memory - Upper□school Socratic discussion/seminars/debate; logic skills - Upper□school rhetoric training and opportunities to speak

1) Keywords/phrases found in school materials:

- “Teachers employ... memorization, recitation, and songs” in Grammar stage; “songs, chants, and rhymes fill our grammar school” (memory work)
- Logic stage: “debate and discussion”; Rhetoric stage: students “produce and defend” ideas; “thesis defense,” “eloquent written and oral communication” (Socratic/discussion/debate; rhetoric)
- “education is also a type of play... at leisure to study and to play” (restful learning/leisure)

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Strong positive matches to memory/recitation/chanting, debate/discussion, logic/rhetoric training, and leisure (scholé) signals; no “project□based/experiential learning” dominance evident.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +9
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage: 1.00

4) Rating: CLASSICAL Rationale: Multiple explicit pedagogical practices match the classical lexicon from K□12.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Required criteria: - Teachers as models/mentors of virtue, knowledge, skill - Faculty as a collegial “living curriculum”; “faculty of friends” - Clear portrait/profile of teacher and student

1) Keywords/phrases found in school materials:

- “All our teachers... professed Christians... committed to teaching... from a Christian perspective” (formation)
- “model proper behavior... maintain order... subject□matter experts” and “model the pursuit of knowledge in a humble way” (teachers as models; intellectual humility)
- “train and observe our teachers diligently and provide ongoing educational opportunities” (formation of faculty)

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Positive matches to “teachers as models of virtue,” “intellectual humility,” and ongoing formation; no explicit “faculty of friends/collegial culture” or a published “portrait of a teacher/student” surfaced in the crawl snippets.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +6
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage: ~0.50–0.67 (models/formation evident; collegial “faculty of friends” and explicit “portrait” not evident)

- 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Rationale: Strong modeling/formation language; additional explicit articulation of a faculty/graduate portrait and collegial identity would complete the picture.
-

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Required criteria: - Parents as partners/co-teachers - Parent education/formation - Parents welcomed/integrated into school life

- 1) Keywords/phrases found in school materials:

- “collaborative model... co-teachers... significant time teaching and training parents who serve as co-teachers” (parent partnership and formation)
- “lesson plans... available to parents... teachers have office hours on homeschool days” (ongoing parent support)
- Mission speaks of “co-laboring with families” (shared mission)

- 2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Strong positive matches to “parent partnership,” “co-educators,” and “parent formation”; no signals of minimal parent involvement or consumer framing found.

- 3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +8
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage: ~0.80 (clear partnership and training; explicit “parents welcome any time” policy not observed in the snippets)

- 4) Rating: CLASSICAL Rationale: The collaborative co-teacher model and structured parent training clearly embody the classical community ideal.
-

Overall Assessment

Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL - 5 categories scored CLASSICAL; 1 category (Faculty) scored SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL based on partial coverage of collegial/portrait elements. The school’s mission, curricular core (Trivium/Latin/Great Books), pedagogical practices (chant/recitation, discussion/debate, rhetoric/senior thesis), theological integration, and parent partnership are exemplary within the classical Christian tradition.

Detailed Keyword Crosswalk (samples)

- Positive matches used for scoring drew from the Six Essential Elements lexicon: “truth, goodness, beauty,” “wisdom,” “virtue,” “theology,” “Great Books,” “Trivium,” “Latin,” “Socratic/discussion,” “chanting/memorization/recitation,” “rhetoric/thesis,” “leisure/scholé,” “parent partnership”.
 - Negative indicators (e.g., “values-neutral,” “career readiness,” “project-based learning dominance,” “social studies replacing history”) did not appear in the materials reviewed.
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.